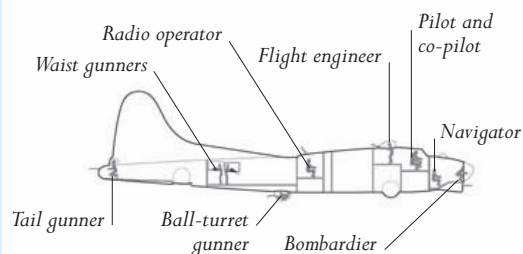


INSIDE THE B-17

Much of the B-17's slim fuselage was taken up by the bomb bay. The pilot and co-pilot in the cockpit, and the flight engineer behind them, were relatively comfortable, as were the radio operator, bombardier, and navigator, though the latter two had to squirm into their positions in the nose via a narrow opening. The tail and ball-turret gunners, however, had to be contortionists to reach their places. They and the waist gunners wore electrically-heated suits.



CROSS-SECTION

THE OXYGEN SUPPLY



▲ OXYGEN REGULATOR

Each crewman was supplied with oxygen from a central source. He used a portable bottle (below) if he needed to move around the aircraft.



▲ CENTRAL SUPPLY

There were 18 large oxygen cylinders in the lower fuselage. Oxygen was vital at the B-17's operating height of over 7,600m (25,000ft).

FLIGHT DECK AND FUSELAGE



▲ FLIGHT DECK

Both the pilot, who sat on the left, and the co-pilot had a control yoke, with the throttle controls for each individual engine located between the two of them.

► FORWARD VIEW

Looking towards the radio operator's position from the starboard waist gun, the fuselage ribs are clearly visible. The black column supports the ball turret below the fuselage.



▼ PITCH CONTROLS

The propellers' pitch and the throttle settings had to be adjusted to regulate the aircraft's airspeed, and this required the attention of both men.



▲ CONTROL CABLES

Cables running from the flight deck through the fuselage to the control surfaces activated the rudder, ailerons, and elevators.